

Content of analysis.

The piece of content I chose for my analysis is the New York Times article “The New Fabio Is Claude” by Alexandra Alter that was published Feb. 8, 2026 [1]. The main message of the content is the use of AI in writing romance books by the author Coral Hart. The article mentions statistics about the number of books she wrote and sold in a year, descriptions of her generating/writing strategies and information about her business which offers courses on how to write books with AI. The article was widely discussed due to its topic, so I chose this content as the unit of my analysis. Note: Throughout the report the word “author” refers to Coral Hart and not to the author of the article.

Sampling.

I searched for both the article's title and the name of the author separately on Google Search, Reddit and social media platforms such as Instagram, Tiktok, YouTube and X. I also searched for broader topics such as “AI and books”, “AI and Romance” to look for cases where the article could be referenced. I selected sources that referenced the article and not sources where Coral Hart was mentioned independently of it.

Methodology.

The main goal of my analysis is to examine how the article is used and interpreted. An important part here is to analyze how it changes across platforms, types of usage of the content and other identified criterias.

I created a spreadsheet with a classification framework and applied it to each of the collected sources (n = 12).

Classifications:

1. Use of content: Reference (mention of article while the main topic is something different), Discussion (article is central part of conversation with a lot of assessment and opinions), Reuse of ideas (application of mentioned strategies), Retelling (summary/repost without assessment)
2. Platform
3. Type of content: Long/Short text, Video
4. Position towards article/New York Times (further will be referenced as NYT): Positive, Negative, Neutral
5. Position towards the message in the article/usage of AI in writing books: Positive, Negative, Neutral
6. References: Statistics, Quotes from the author, Quotes from publishers, Author's business, Title of the article, AI writing process details. This classification category shows which part of the content other people refer to when they use the article.
7. Aim of use: Critique of article/NYT, Critique of author/AI, Critique of publishers/editors/companies, Support for author/AI, Support for article/NYT, Informing

(summary of the article), Strategic use, Broader discussion. This classification category indicates for what purpose the content was used for and how it was reshaped in the end.

Results.

1. Platforms.

The content was used in media platforms characterized by publication of long texts like Substack, Medium, Aftermath, also on Reddit and social media platforms such as X, Instagram, Threads, Youtube and LinkedIn.

Position towards the message of the article and its interpretation differed depending on the platform.

Most of the content with a positive position towards the message covered in the article were found in Reddit which is mostly due to activity of communities focusing on writing books with AI [2, 3, 4]. They interpreted the article strategically and positively while general communities on other platforms interpreted it as a threat.

Platforms with format of long posts such as Substack were more likely to criticize NYT/article and interpret the article as media controversy while there was no mention of the opinion towards the article on sources from social media such as Instagram, X, Youtube [5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11].

2. Use of content.

The most common type of usage was discussion. It was mostly used as 1) part of a bigger discussion about the book industry, ethics of AI; 2) as critique of the author, article/NYT or the actors in the publishing industry.

The article was also used as a shared summary of the article with a neutral position, as strategic reuse of pro-AI ideas and reference to the author in announcement of pro-AI events [2, 4, 12].

3. Negative position towards article/NYT.

Both pro-AI and anti-AI users criticized the NYT article but they did it differently.

Content by pro-AI users mostly criticised manipulation of facts while referring to author's numbers of written and sold books [3, 13]. Those with a negative position towards the AI also referred to these statistics but they criticized the article for not providing evidence for the numbers and for the lack of skepticism towards AI-generated books [6, 7, 8].

4. References.

Information from the article that was used the most are statistics and quotes of the author. Numbers of published books per year, revenue of the author were used as support for the pro-AI argument about efficiency and also as part of discussion about threats for publishing industry in anti-AI argument [4, 5, 6, 11].

Different parts of the content were used depending on the position of users to the message of the article. Pro-AI users were mostly referring to statistics and writing process details while

anti-AI discussed a lot of the quotes from the author where she referred to book publishing as a “race” [1].

Additional framework.

I also implemented some elements of the SWOT framework to identify perceived concerns (“threats”) and responses (“opportunities”) to the spread of AI-generated books that were mentioned in discussion of the article. It was not applicable to implement it completely since the goal of this framework does not entirely fit the case of this analysis, so I focused on perceived threats and opportunities related to AI in the book industry. Examples of perceived threats included: AI stealing from other authors, difficulties in detecting AI-generated content, publishers not disclosing usage of AI. Opportunities to limit negative effects included: strengthening the selection process of works, employee training to better detect AI-generated content, readers still valuing the quality of books made by humans. The analysis shows that most of the mentioned threats are about the present state of the AI’s place in the industry while opportunities refer mostly to potential strategies that should be implemented in the future.

Taken together, the article was mostly used as broader discussions about books generated by AI, critique of media coverage, support for pro-AI arguments and promotional material which all differed depending on the platform and user’s position toward AI and the article.

Suggestion for automatization of analysis.

Topic modeling could be used for identifying repeated subtopics in the discussions that can be then turned into categories of classification. Also, structural topic modeling could be applied to compare how subtopics differ depending on the platform, position of user or type of use of content. For large-scale data collection, API and web scraping methods could be used to collect comments, posts, discussions in Reddit.

References:

- [1] <https://www.nytimes.com/2026/02/08/business/ai-claude-romance-books.html>
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- [11] <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6n3QTOdxLv0&t=633s>

[12]

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[13] <https://theinvisiblepen.substack.com/p/the-nyt-called-claude-the-new-fabio-2d6>